

INTERNATIONAL news

Trump slams CHIPS Act and calls for repeal

Donald Trump criticised the CHIPS and Science Act, calling it a waste of taxpayer money and urging its repeal. He argued that funds should go toward reducing the national debt. However, supporters defend the Act's potential to revitalise US semiconductor manufacturing, citing investments by companies like TSMC and Micron to create jobs and boost the economy.

TSMC commits \$100 billion to US manufacturing expansion

TSMC will invest \$100 billion to expand semiconductor manufacturing in the US, building two new plants in Arizona, and adding to its existing facilities. This move, supported by the CHIPS Act, aims to create thousands of jobs and strengthen US tech production, reducing reliance on foreign-made chips and boosting global competitiveness.

Apple pledges \$500 billion for its US capabilities

Apple is investing \$500 billion in the US over the next four years, marking its largest-ever investment. This includes a new manufacturing facility for AI servers in Houston and a skill development academy in Detroit. Apple also plans to create 20,000 jobs, focusing on AI, silicon engineering, and advanced manufacturing.

Nvidia-supported robotics startup Field AI eyes \$2 billion valuation

California-based robotics startup Field AI is in talks to raise several hundred million dollars, pushing its valuation to \$2 billion, up from \$500 million last year. Backed by Nvidia and specialising in AI models for robotics in the construction and oil industries, Field AI generates revenue by integrating software with hardware from major manufacturers like Boston Dynamics.

Allegro MicroSystems rejects onsemi's \$6.9 billion acquisition proposal

Onsemi has proposed acquiring Allegro MicroSystems for \$6.9 billion, offering \$35.10 per share—57% above its market value. The acquisition aims to combine its strengths in automotive, industrial, and AI technologies. The proposal was spurned by Allegro, following which Allegro traded significantly lower on the stock market, trading well below Onsemi's proposed takeout price. Onsemi urged Allegro's board to engage in discussions, emphasising the strategic benefits and immediate shareholder value.

HP to move 90% of production outside China

Hewlett-Packard (HP) plans to move 90% of its production out of China by 2025 end, driven by trade tensions and rising tariffs. This strategy aims to improve supply chain resilience, but it may result in up to 2000 job cuts. HP is also stockpiling inventory to mitigate potential tariff increases and control costs.

Foxconn maintains upbeat forecast despite 13% decline in profits

Taiwan's Foxconn announced that solid demand from its tech clients would drive strong revenue growth in the first quarter despite a 13% decline in net profits. Foxconn booked an October-December net profit of T\$46.33 billion (\$1.41 billion). The profit decline was Foxconn's first since the second quarter of 2023, when it fell 0.9%, and largely stemmed from an investment loss in Japan's Sharp and currency exchange losses. In January, Foxconn said October-December revenue jumped 15.2% to a record on strong AI server sales for that quarter.

Microchip slashes workforce by 9% due to automotive decline

Microchip Technology plans to cut 2000 jobs, or 9% of its workforce, due to declining automotive sales and surplus chip inventories. The Arizona-based company will sell its integrated circuit die to a Chinese partner amid US-China tensions. The restructuring aims to reduce costs by \$100 million annually.

Infineon secures €1 billion funding for Dresden power fab

Infineon Technologies has secured €1 billion in funding from the European Chips Act for its €5 billion Smart Power Fab project in Dresden, set to open in 2026. The initiative will create 1000 jobs, enhance microelectronics innovation, drive decarbonisation and digitalisation, and bolster Europe's semiconductor industry and supply chains.

Harwin expands with £30 million sustainable manufacturing site in UK

Harwin is building a £30 million eco-friendly manufacturing facility in Portsmouth, UK, to double production capacity by 2026. The site will support the aerospace, defence, and industrial sectors, featuring rooftop solar panels, EV charging, and bike-friendly infrastructure. It aims to enhance supply chain stability and set new sustainability standards.

Keysight, Samsung, and Nvidia collaborate on AI-driven RAN

Keysight, Samsung, and Nvidia have unveiled an AI-driven model to enhance 5G-advanced and 6G RAN performance. The model improves throughput, system capacity, and power efficiency, addressing challenges like uplink performance at the cell edge. Demonstrated at MWC 2025, it showed a 30% improvement in cell edge throughput, marking a major step toward more efficient, AI-powered networks.

Apple breaks free from Qualcomm with custom modem

Apple has unveiled its first custom modem chip, removing Qualcomm dependency. Featured in the iPhone 16e, this chip forms part of Apple's new C1 subsystem, enhancing battery life and integrating advanced AI features manufactured using 4nm and 7nm technologies. However, it will not support millimetre-wave 5G yet, where Qualcomm excels.

SECO integrates Qualcomm Tech for next-gen embedded systems

SECO has partnered with Qualcomm Technologies to integrate Qualcomm's Dragonwing processors and Snapdragon X series platforms into SECO's embedded solutions. This collaboration, showcased at Embedded World 2025, will enhance SECO's product portfolio, supporting industrial applications like HMIs, AI, machine vision, and edge computing for improved performance and energy efficiency.

Volkswagen announces five-year plan for EV future

Volkswagen has unveiled a bold five-year plan to lead the EV market by 2030. The strategy includes launching affordable electric cars, cutting over 35,000 jobs, and transforming its Wolfsburg plant into a high-tech hub for compact electric vehicle production. The company aims to become the top EV manufacturer by 2030.